

Instructions To Store all sensitive values

Store all sensitive values in a `.env` file and access them using `process.env`. Never commit the `.env` file to GitHub.

1. Install dotenv

```
npm install dotenv
```

2. Create a `.env` file

```
# =====  
# API Authentication Credentials  
# =====  
  
# OpenWeatherMap API Key  
OPENWEATHER_API_KEY=YOUR_OPENWEATHER_API_KEY  
  
# TheCatAPI Key  
CAT_API_KEY=YOUR_CAT_API_KEY  
  
# GitHub Personal Access Token  
GITHUB_TOKEN=YOUR_GITHUB_PERSONAL_ACCESS_TOKEN  
  
# Basic Authentication Credentials  
BASIC_AUTH_USERNAME=postman  
BASIC_AUTH_PASSWORD=password
```

3. Load `.env`

At the top of your test file:

```
import dotenv from 'dotenv'; // Import the dotenv package to load environment variables
    from a .env file
    dotenv.config(); // Load environment variables from the .env file
```

5. Recommended `.gitignore`

Never commit your `.env` file.

```
# Environment variables
.env
.env.*

# Ignore Playwright reports
playwright-report/
test-results/

# Ignore Node modules
node_modules/
```

6. Project Structure

```
Playwright_API_Project
|
├── .env
├── .gitignore
├── package.json
├── playwright.config.ts
|
├── tests
|   └── api_authentication.spec.ts
|
└── node_modules
```

Benefits of using `.env`

-  Keeps API keys and tokens secure.
-  Prevents sensitive credentials from being pushed to GitHub.
-  Makes it easy to switch between development, staging, and production environments.
-  Follows industry best practices for Playwright, Node.js, and API automation projects.
-  Makes your tests reusable across different machines without modifying the test code.